SkillNavora

MODULE 13 HANDBOOK

Module 13: Contact Builder and Data Designer

3 sections, 19 topics explained, plus the detailed lessons, examples, exercises and official links.

Salesforce Marketing Cloud (SFMC) Academy. Verify product names, editions, licences and certifications on Salesforce's official pages.

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Edition: November 2026. Practice labs marked "account" need a provisioned Marketing Cloud account. Other labs use sample files or paper.

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Module 13: Contact Builder and Data Designer

Level: Intermediate. Contact Builder: attribute groups, relationships and the contact model.

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Detailed lessons

Module 13

13.1 Attribute groups and relationships

WHAT IS IT?

> Attribute groups bring fields from several data extensions into one contact view. One-to-one and one-to-many relationships link them through contact keys.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

> A clear contact model is the base of multi-business-unit and Customer 360 designs.

HOW DOES IT WORK AND THE STEPS

1. Create an attribute group from the contact's data extensions.
2. Link tables with the contact key.
3. Check that one contact returns one row per attribute group where expected.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

> Contact (1) to orders (many): an attribute group for orders shows the most recent order fields.

COMMON ERRORS

Joining one-to-many data and expecting one row per contact.

INTERVIEW QUESTION

What is an attribute group?

HANDS-ON EXERCISE

Model a customer with orders and loyalty tables in an attribute group design.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION AND FURTHER READING

- Salesforce Help: Marketing Cloud Engagement

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13.2 Contact governance and deletion

WHAT IS IT?

> Contact deletion and retention decide how long personal data is kept. Governance records who owns the model and who may change it.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

> Retention is a legal requirement in many regions.

HOW DOES IT WORK AND THE STEPS

1. Define retention per data extension.
2. Document contact deletion requests.
3. Review the contact model yearly.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

> A deletion request removes the contact and its linked records within the agreed time.

COMMON ERRORS

Keeping personal data forever.

INTERVIEW QUESTION

How do you handle a deletion request in SFMC?

HANDS-ON EXERCISE

Write a deletion procedure for a privacy request.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION AND FURTHER READING

- Salesforce Help: Marketing Cloud Engagement

13.1 Contact Builder Fundamentals: every topic explained

Contact Builder navigation. Contacts, Data Designer, Data Extensions, Imports and Data Sources.

Contact model. How contacts link to channel and custom data.

Contact relationships. Links from the contact to attribute groups and data extensions.

Attribute groups. Groups of related data extensions linked to the contact.

Data Designer. The visual tool to link data extensions to contacts.

13.2 Attribute Groups: every topic explained

Creating attribute groups. Create a group, link a data extension to the contact key, then add related tables.

Data extension relationships. Links defined between fields in data extensions.

One-to-one relationships. One row per contact, such as a profile.

One-to-many relationships. Many rows per contact, such as orders.

Contact key relationships. Relationships that start from the contact key.

Data model design. A clear model for journeys and segmentation.

13.3 Contact Management: every topic explained

Contact deletion. Removing a contact and its data on request.

Contact status. Active or pending deletion.

Contact population. How many contacts the account holds, which can affect licence counts.

Contact identity. Consistent identification across channels.

Subscriber key. Email Studio identifier; keep it equal to the contact key.

Contact key. Contact Builder identifier.

Data retention. Keeping contact data only as long as needed.

Contact governance. Rules and ownership for the contact model.